SANSKAR LOHANI

IAM Engineer

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with 3+ years building authentication and access control for client applications, including managing 200+ Active Directory users across 4+ client environments. Built hands-on IAM labs in AWS and Entra ID covering SAML and OIDC SSO, least-privilege RBAC and access automation. Holds an M.S. in Cybersecurity, AZ-500 and Security+, and is currently training in SailPoint IdentityIQ.

EXPERIENCE

Staris HR Services **Jan 2020 - Jul 2023**

Software Engineer *Kathmandu, Nepal*

- Administered 200+ Active Directory users and 7+ groups across 4+ client environments, provisioning and de-provisioning access.
- Integrated AD groups with AWS IAM roles, which turned granting or removing AWS access into a single group change.
- Implemented JWT authentication and role-based authorization in Express middleware, with passwords stored as bcrypt hashes.
- Protected client web applications from brute-force attacks with login rate limiting, and blocked privilege escalation with role checks on every API route.
- Strengthened client API security with input validation and secure session handling against malformed and injected requests.
- Consolidated CloudTrail audit logs from client AWS accounts in Sentinel for centralized security monitoring and audit review.
- Delivered client releases to AWS through CodePipeline and CodeBuild CI/CD pipelines, keeping builds consistent across separate client environments.
- Developed web applications and REST APIs for 10+ international clients with Node.js, Express and MongoDB.

Florida International University **Aug 2024 - Apr 2026**

Graduate Teaching Assistant *Miami, FL*

- Engineered Linux autograder scripts that compiled and tested every submission, cutting manual grading for 100+ students.
- Evaluated C and Operating Systems projects over SSH and wrote feedback on design, logic and error handling.
- Coached students one-on-one through debugging and cleared up common misconceptions about C, Linux and OS concepts.

SKILLS

Identity & Access: IAM, SAML 2.0, OIDC, SSO, MFA, RBAC, least privilege, permission boundaries, Active Directory, Microsoft Entra ID, just-in-time access, user provisioning, access reviews, identity lifecycle management, federation, LDAP, SailPoint IdentityIQ
AWS: IAM, IAM Identity Center, Lambda, DynamoDB, EventBridge, CloudTrail, CloudWatch, GuardDuty, Security Hub, IAM Access Analyzer, Secrets Manager, Systems Manager, S3, EC2, SNS, SQS, CodePipeline, CodeBuild
Microsoft & Azure: Sentinel, KQL, Defender XDR, Logic Apps (SOAR), Microsoft Graph, Log Analytics, Azure Firewall, incident response
Code & Tools: Python, Java, C, JavaScript (Node.js), Express, SQL (MySQL), MongoDB, PowerShell, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Git, Linux, SSH
Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, NIST SP 800-53

PROJECTS

SecureCorp AWS IAM Lab | github.com/slohani-22/SecureCorp-AWS-IAM-Lab

- Modeled RBAC for a multi-department company with 5 IAM users, 4 groups, 10 least-privilege policies, MFA and permission boundaries, with core setup in Terraform.
- Federated Entra ID with AWS IAM Identity Center over SAML 2.0 for SSO and configured OIDC for GitHub Actions to eliminate stored access keys.
- Automated identity lifecycle management with 5 Python Lambda functions for joiner provisioning, just-in-time access requests tracked in DynamoDB, and weekly stale-access reviews from the IAM credential report.
- Secured and monitored the environment with keyless Secrets Manager access for EC2, 6 CloudWatch alarms for root use, MFA deactivation and IAM policy changes, and CloudTrail streaming into Sentinel.
- Audited the completed lab and documented 3 findings with root causes and fixes, including a revoke rule with no target that left a 5-minute grant attached for about 170 days and 4 SCPs with no effect in a single-account organization.

Microsoft Sentinel SIEM Lab | github.com/slohani-22/Microsoft-Sentinel-SIEM-Lab

- Created 16 custom KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK for brute force, privileged role assignment, PowerShell abuse, scheduled tasks, lateral movement, data staging and DNS command-and-control.
- Validated detections with an 8-stage attack simulation that fired 4 incidents and exposed 2 detection gaps.
- Investigated 3 incidents end to end and produced incident reports on a PowerShell download cradle, a hidden scheduled task, and DNS command-and-control correlated across endpoint and firewall logs.
- Reduced account containment to 3.99 seconds with a Logic Apps SOAR playbook, disabling compromised accounts via Microsoft Graph.
- Reviewed detection quality after testing, documented false positives on 2 noisy rules and recommended tuning changes for each.

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500) **2026**
CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) **2026**

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical and Electronics Engineering | Kathmandu University, Nepal **Mar 2023**
Master of Science, Cybersecurity | Florida International University, Miami, FL **Apr 2026**